# Automotive data capabilities

auto.dev and mcp.vin | Scope of available data and developer access

auto.dev entries reflect its public product descriptions. mcp.vin entries reflect the verified release 1.5.0. This is a scope comparison, not a test of relative accuracy, coverage or service performance.

| Capability | auto.dev advertises [1] | mcp.vin implementation [2] |
|---|---|---|
| VIN decoding | Global VIN decode | **Partial.** NHTSA vPIC decoding and validation; US-oriented coverage. |
| Specifications | VIN-based specifications | **Partial.** vPIC fields, EPA configurations and Canadian dimensions. |
| Factory equipment | OEM build data | **Gap.** Exact factory options, paint and option pricing are not verified. |
| Plate lookup | Plate-to-VIN | **Gap.** No verified free nationwide source integrated. |
| Inventory | Vehicle listings | **Gap.** No nationwide inventory feed integrated. |
| Photography | Vehicle photos | **Partial.** Representative stock images; no exact-VIN photo coverage. |
| Interest rates | APR endpoint | **Partial.** Dated Federal Reserve benchmark; no personalized quote. |
| Loan payments | Payment calculations | **Partial.** Amortization from entered APR, taxes, fees and term. |
| Taxes and fees | Tax and fee endpoint | **Gap.** Entered amounts only; no jurisdiction-specific lookup. |
| Ownership costs | Ownership-cost endpoint | **Partial.** Editable cost scenarios; no resale or repair-cost prediction. |
| Recall campaigns | Recall endpoint | **Partial.** Model-year NHTSA campaigns; VIN applicability unconfirmed. |
| Unrepaired recalls | Open-recall endpoint | **Partial.** Ford, GM and Tesla status; Honda active recalls; Mopar open records. Toyota: interactive verification. |
| Developer access | REST, MCP, CLI, SDK | **Implemented.** REST, 22 MCP tools, local JavaScript client and CLI. |

**Assessment:** mcp.vin supports public-data research and transparent cost modeling. It does not yet replace auto.dev across factory build data, inventory, plate lookup or universal VIN recall repair status.

[1] auto.dev product catalog: www.auto.dev; specifications, OEM build and open-recall product pages. Reviewed 24 Oct 2026. Advertised capabilities were not independently benchmarked.
[2] Source: release 1.5.0; source review dated 24 Oct 2026. Partial = narrower scope. Gap = required data not integrated. Implemented does not imply identical data coverage.

# Data sources and methodology

mcp.vin | Evidence, coverage and appropriate use

| Primary source | Implemented use | Interpretation |
|---|---|---|
| NHTSA vPIC [1] | VIN decoding and submitted vehicle attributes | US-oriented manufacturer records; completeness varies by vehicle. |
| EPA / FuelEconomy.gov [2] | Configurations, emissions, energy assumptions and owner MPG | Test configuration data. Owner reports are voluntary; sample size and method are shown. |
| Transport Canada via vPIC [1] | Dimensions and curb mass | Canadian model variants. Select the appropriate configuration; not an exact-VIN match. |
| NHTSA ODI archives [3] | Manufacturer communications and defect investigations | Dated local indexes. Report variants and provenance retained; not a vehicle-level defect finding. |
| Federal Reserve G.19 [4] | New-car loan rate context | Manual snapshot: Aug 2026 observations, released 7 Oct 2026. Not a lender offer. |

## Verified implementation

**93 Node tests** and two index integrity tests passed. Live checks exercised REST, the JavaScript client and MCP. The interface was reviewed on desktop and at 390-pixel width. This is implementation verification, not an independent accuracy certification. Investigation index: **5,351 distinct actions** across 154,439 association rows. The manufacturer-communications index contains 5,834,958 vehicle/component associations across seven archives; that is not a count of unique bulletins.

## Illustrative source check

2003 Honda Accord V6 automatic, EPA ID 18657: **22 combined EPA MPG**; **23.5 owner-reported harmonic mean MPG** from 29 submitted records, range 15-34 MPG. These measures use different methods and samples. The Honda Accord 2003 investigation query returned five distinct actions. Values reflect the 24 Oct 2026 UTC verification.

## Professional use

**Confirm the configuration.** Model-year records do not establish exact factory equipment.
**Read manufacturer coverage.** Ford, GM and Tesla report VIN status; Honda reports active recalls (15 years). Mopar supplies open records; Toyota needs interactive verification. GM closure is not always repair; only explicit repair dates are shown.
**Review assumptions and dates.** Cost results use entered assumptions; snapshots can become outdated.

## Sources and verification basis

[1] vpic.nhtsa.dot.gov/api/
[2] fueleconomy.gov/feg/ws/
[3] nhtsa.gov/nhtsa-datasets-and-apis
[4] federalreserve.gov/releases/g19/20261007/
Source reference: docs/data-sources.md; verified release 1.5.0. No paid data provider is required for these research features. Hosting, maintenance and source availability remain operational considerations.